

1979: THE FINAL SCORE

It's that time of year to make a list and check it twice. Here are some lists of a different sort for your holiday amusement. Some are naughty, some are nice, but all are aimed strictly at the funny bone. Some even have a few New Year's resolutions tossed in for sports fans' consideration. 1979: The Final Score was compiled and edited by Vince Langford and John Laird.

Ten good country-western songs available for recording in 1980

1. "Mamas, Don't Let Your Babies Grow Up to Be Cowboys" by Hum Phillips
2. "Take This Job and Shove It" by Frank Kush
3. "Your Cheatin' Heart" by Norm Ellenberger
4. "I'm So Lonesome, I Could Cry" by Bubba Garcia
5. "Cryin' Time Again" by Don Haskins
6. "Happiest Girl in the Whole USA" by Patsy Norman
7. "Rhino Stone Cowboy" by Jim Paul
8. "I've Always Been Crazy" by Paul Strelzin
9. "Tiger by the Tail" by Bill Michael
10. "When You're Hot, You're Hot" by John Felmer

Ten nice things about 'Humble' Howard Cosell

1. He's not a twin.
2. He's not a relative.
3. He's not Idi Amin.
4. He's not into Ilse Hirsch.
5. He's not in El Paso.
6. He's not running for President.
7. You can't smell him.
8. He's one of ours.
9. He's not armed (but he's dangerous).
10. He doesn't know your phone number.



HOWARD COSELL



Best '79 sports action photograph

When Miss Texas pageant participants interrupted UTEP's first football practice of the fall season, running back William Cash couldn't pass up the opportunity to enjoy some of the finer scenery that

has graced the Sun Bowl in many, many practice sessions. After the beauties finished their posing for aerial photos, however, the beasts got back to work.

Andy Cohen's lists:

(Former Miner baseball coach Andy Cohen played for the New York Giants in the 1930s, had a long career as a player and manager in the minor leagues, and was a coach for the Philadelphia Phillies. His lists include players or managers he watched.)

Best managers

John McGraw, Tris Speaker, Donie Bush, Dave Bancroft, Bill Clymer, Ed Pratt, Ed Sawyer, Ray Brubaker, Gene Mauch, Al Mauer.

Best minor leaguers

Joe Hauser, Spencer Harris, Ike Boone, Del Bissone, Paul Richards, Eddie Robinson, Ted Beard, Enos Slaughter, Stan Rojek, Hank Sauer, Al Wright, Buzz Arlett.

Best major league relievers

Fred "Fire" Marberry, Johnny Murphy, Joe Page, Elroy Face, Rolfe Fingers, Bruce Sutter, Mike Marshall, Kent Tekulve, Mark Clear.

Best players, college ranks

Steve Powers, Alan Bannister, Bob Horn, Ron Hasey, Chris Bando, Hubie Brooks, Mark Miller, Charlie West, Brandt Humphrey, Ken Reed.

Pitchers: Mark Bombard, Steve Powers, Dave Crutcher, Floyd Bannister, Dan Schatzeder.

Best major league stars

National League: Frank Frisch, Rogers Hornsby, Jim Bottomly, Paul Waner, Kiki Cuyler, Ernie Banks, Gabby Hartnett, Willie Mays, Hank Aaron, Pie Traynor, Travis Jackson, Glenn Wright.

American League: Babe Ruth, Ty Cobb, Tris Speaker, George Sider, Joe DiMaggio, Ted Williams, Jimmy Fox, Carl Yastrzemski, Al Simmons, Lou Gehrig, Bill Dickey, Mickey Cochrane.

Best pitchers

National League: Dazzy Vance, Burleigh Grimes, Carl Hubbell, Bill Hallahan, Warren Sahn, Pat Malone, Larry Benton.

American League: Lefty Grove, Lefty Gomez, Bob Feller, Bob Lemon, Ted Lyons.

A typical UTEP basketball player's seven favorite meals on the road

1. A Whataburger and large fries in Waco, Texas.
2. Four bags of Korn Nuts and three Cokes at Kansas City airport.
3. Last of bread and package of bologna at Laramie Tort-N-Totem.
4. Fried chicken at Chinese restaurant in Salt Lake City.
5. Barbecue ribs at Chinese restaurant in Salt Lake City.
6. Fried shrimp at Chinese restaurant in Salt Lake City.
7. 18 complimentary packages of Continental Airlines almonds and 3 milks.

Nolan Richardson's hardest sports tasks

(Note: Nolan Richardson, basketball coach and athletic director at No. 1 ranked Western Texas College in Snyder, Texas, was a standout basketball player and football player. After basketball team, and was agreed to play, both pro football and pro basketball. He coached Bowie High School to basketball prominence before going on to WTC.)

1. Putting golf.
2. Getting your golf score in the 60s or 70s.
3. Consistently hitting a golf ball straight.
4. Coaching desire or "beat" into a person with none.
5. Increasing your jumping ability.
6. Swinging at a baseball thrown at speeds of 90-100 mph.

Mini-Lists:

Best comment by a basketball player regarding BYU's Mormons

"Why do they call them Mormons?"

Six boxing matches we'd pay to see

El "Too Tall" Jones vs. Wilt Chamberlain
Billy Martin vs. George Steinbrenner
Frank Kush vs. Woody Hayes
Tom Landry vs. The Devil
Thomas Henderson vs. The Pittsburgh Steelers
Howard Cosell vs. any truck driver

Phrases you won't hear when UTEP's football team starts winning

1. "They practiced so when we kicked."
2. "I wished they hadn't done that but they did."
3. "We're a young football team and we play like a young football team."
4. "Our offense is inconsistent."
5. "Our offense just didn't execute."
6. "We executed but we were inconsistent."
7. "We executed inconsistently."
8. "We're just inconsistently young."

Diablo GM Jim Paul's lists:

- Five Best Promotions
 1. San Diego Super Chicken.
 2. Pan National Jacket Night.
 3. Eleven Opening Nights.
 4. 1974 Southern Union Gas Bar Night.
 5. 25-cent Beer Nights.
- Best Diablo Players
 1. Carole Landford (California Angels, 3b).
 2. Jerry Remy (Boston Red Sox, 2b).
 3. Sid Monge (Cleveland Indians, pitcher).
 4. Dave Collins (Cincinnati Reds, outfielder).
 5. Ron Jackson (Minnesota Twins, infielder).
 6. Mark Clear (California Angels, pitcher).
 - 10 Favorite People in Baseball
 1. Bobby Bragan (former president of National Association and Texas League).
 2. Moose Stubing (former manager of El Paso Diablos).
 - Bob Foutaine (general manager, San Diego Padres).
 - Dave Garcia (manager, Cleveland Indians).
 - Warren Spahn (Hall of Famer and pitching coach, California Angels).
 - Bob "Buck" Rodgers (third base coach, Milwaukee Brewers).
 - Sparky Anderson (manager, Detroit Tigers).
 - Willie Saunders (former general manager, Albuquerque Dukes).
 - Jack Donnan (general manager, Tucson Toros).
 - El Paso Diablos fans.
 - Most Memorable Nights
 1. Third and final game of the 1978 Texas League Championship series, with El Paso winning the title.
 2. Opening night of the 1977 season, breaking single night attendance record with over 8,300 fans, and then again, three nights later, breaking that record with 9,303 fans.
 3. Bowie Kuhn, commissioner of

baseball, coming to Dudley Field in 1977.

4. Any of the Chicken nights.
5. 18-inning game that lasted until 2:30 a.m. (1975).
6. Final game, first half of 1978 season, game tied 9-9 and Terry Stepi hit a double to win the playoff berth for the Diablos.
7. Final 10-game streak of the 1978 season. Diablos had to win all 10 to keep from mathematically being eliminated. El Paso won all 10 and then the three consecutive championship games.
8. Three home runs by third baseman Butch Alberts in one game (1978).
9. Marty Friedman making a diving catch over the center field hump for a ball hit over his head (1975).
10. Former New York Mets manager Joe Frazier, then with Memphis, threatened PA announcer Paul Strelzin with physical violence between double headers (1975).

'The Mouth' roars: Paul Strelzin's lists:

- FAVORITE DIABLO NICKNAMES
1. Doctor Marty Friedman — "al-ways on call to solve game problems; can cure all the team's ills."
 2. Shotgun John Balaz — "rifled the ball into and over the right field fence (still playing with Jaree Indians)."
 3. Willie "Ask Ask" Aikens — "his bat made hits that came out fast and furious like an Army anti-aircraft gun."
 4. Midnight Mike Miley — "a crash mixed a fantastic career in the 'bod."
 5. Paul Dade "The Executioner" — "he was the death knell for any pitcher."
 6. Ron "Popper" Farkis — "tatoo on his arm and larceny in his heart; strong and reliable."
 7. The Bulcher Boy, Butch Alberts



FROM DUDLEY FIELD TO SPECIAL EVENTS CENTER
This decade, Strelzin has been, well, at least unforgettable